# BitcoinTX CSV Import Guide

## Overview

The CSV Import feature allows you to bulk-import your Bitcoin transaction history into BitcoinTX. This is useful for:

- Setting up a new installation with existing data
- Migrating from another tracking system
- Restoring from a CSV backup

**Important:** The database must be empty before importing. Then every cost basis is figured from one complete history. If you have existing transactions, delete them first from the Settings page. To add an exchange's own CSV export to a ledger in use, use Settings → Import from an exchange instead.

## Quick Start Guide

### Step 1: Download the Template

Go to Settings → Data Management and click "Template" under Import Transactions (CSV). This gives you a CSV file with the correct column headers and sample rows.

### Step 2: Fill in Your Data

Open the template in a spreadsheet application (Excel, Google Sheets, etc.) and replace the sample rows with your actual transaction data. Delete any sample rows you don't need.

### Step 3: Preview the Import

Upload your CSV file and click "Preview". The system validates all rows and shows you any errors or warnings. Fix any issues before proceeding.

### Step 4: Execute the Import

If the preview shows no errors, click "Import" to create all transactions. The import is atomic – if anything fails, no transactions are created.

# Field Reference

## CSV Columns

| Column | Required | Description |
|---|---|---|
| date | Yes | Date/time (ISO8601 preferred). Without a timezone it is in your tax timezone (Settings → Account); a date alone means noon |
| type | Yes | Transaction type: Deposit, Withdrawal, Transfer, Buy, Sell |
| amount | Yes | BTC (up to 8 decimals), or USD for a dollar account's rows (a bank, an exchange's USD). BTC Transfer: what left the account, fee included. USD Transfer (between dollar accounts): what arrived, fee on top. Withdrawal: what the recipient got, fee on top |
| from_account | Yes | Source account: one of your accounts by its name in Settings, or External |
| to_account | Yes | Destination account: one of your accounts by its name in Settings, or External |
| cost_basis_usd | Conditional | Buy: USD paid for the BTC, before the fee (the fee column is added to the basis). BTC Deposit: required (0 if unknown); Income/Interest/Reward/Rebate blank = that hour's value; Inherited: its value on the date of death, blank = that day's value |
| proceeds_usd | Conditional | Sell: gross USD, before the fee (the fee is subtracted). Spent withdrawal: value received, before the network fee (the fee's value is subtracted); blank = that hour's value |
| fee_amount | No | Fee amount (never also included in cost_basis_usd or proceeds_usd) |
| fee_currency | No | USD or BTC. Blank = USD for a Buy or Sell, else the currency of the account it's paid from (a deposit's: the account it goes into), the only one it may be in |
| source | No | For Deposits: N/A, MyBTC, Gift, Inherited, Income, Interest, Reward, Rebate |
| purpose | Conditional | A BTC withdrawal (from a wallet or an exchange's BTC): Spent, Gift, Donation or Lost. From a bank or an exchange's USD: any short text on one line, or blank; Spent, Gift, Donation or Lost isn't kept there |
| notes | No | Optional notes (not imported, for your reference only) |
| fee_usd | No | Transfer/Withdrawal with a BTC fee: what the fee was worth in USD. Blank = fee x that hour's BTC price |
| fmv_usd | No | Gift, Donation or Lost withdrawal: its fair market value when it left (shown in the tax report); blank = the BTC price when its hour began x the amount (that day's where there's no hourly price), or blank without a price |
| broker_reporting | No | Sell/Withdrawal: only when your broker's 1099-DA/1099-B differs: none, proceeds or basis. Blank = automatic |
| fee_usd_typed | No | With fee_usd: yes (or blank) if you typed that value, no if it came from the price (the export writes it) |
| cost_basis_typed | No | Income/Interest/Reward/Rebate/Inherited deposit with cost_basis_usd: yes (or blank) if you typed it, no if it came from the price (the export writes it) |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| acquired_at | Conditional | MyBTC or Gift deposit into a wallet or an exchange's BTC: when the coins were first acquired (by the giver, for a gift); blank = the deposit's date. Inherited: the date of death (required) |
| proceeds_typed | No | Spent withdrawal with proceeds_usd: yes (or blank) if you typed them, no if they came from the price (the export writes it) |
| price_moment | No | With a value from the price: hour (the BTC price when its hour began, UTC) or day (that day's 00:00 UTC price). Blank = day (the export writes it) |
| fmv_typed | No | Gift/Donation/Lost withdrawal with fmv_usd: yes (or blank) if you typed it, no if it came from the price (the export writes it) |

Settings > Export CSV writes these same columns, so an export imports back to the same ledger.

## Transaction Types

| Type | Description |
|---|---|
| Deposit | Money or BTC coming in from outside (BTC you held elsewhere, a gift received, income; dollars into a bank or an exchange's USD) |
| Withdrawal | Money or BTC leaving (BTC spent, given, donated or lost; dollars out of a bank or an exchange's USD) |
| Transfer | Moving money or BTC between your own accounts (not a sale; a BTC network fee is a small disposal). A wallet to itself: a consolidation, where only the fee is recorded |
| Buy | Purchasing BTC on an exchange with USD |
| Sell | Selling BTC on an exchange for USD |

## Account Names

Bank, Wallet, Exchange USD and Exchange BTC always mean your first bank, wallet and exchange, as in BitcoinTX 1.x's files, whatever they are called now. BTC Fees and USD Fees are the ledger's own: no row names them.

| Account | Description |
|---|---|
| Your accounts | Your banks, wallets and exchanges, each by its name in Settings (in any case). A bank holds USD, a wallet BTC; an exchange has two accounts, "<name> USD" and "<name> BTC". A hidden account still imports, with a warning |
| Bank | Your first bank account (USD) |
| Wallet | Your first self-custody Bitcoin wallet |
| Exchange USD | Your first exchange's USD balance |
| Exchange BTC | Your first exchange's BTC balance |
| External | Outside your portfolio (source for deposits, destination for withdrawals) |

## Source Values (for Deposits)

| Value | Description |
|---|---|
| N/A | Not applicable or unspecified |
| MyBTC | BTC you already owned (transferring in) |
| Gift | Received as a gift (cost_basis_usd: the giver's basis, 0 if unknown) |
| Inherited | Inherited from someone who died: acquired_at is the date of death (required), cost_basis_usd its value that day (or on the estate's alternate valuation date; a Form 8971 value that increased the estate tax caps it); always long-term, INHERITED on Form 8949 |
| Income | Payment for goods/services |
| Interest | Earned as interest |
| Reward | Mining, staking, or a sign-up or referral bonus (income) |
| Rebate | Bitcoin back for spending, such as a rewards card's sats-back (not income; its value is its cost basis) |

## Purpose Values (for BTC Withdrawals)

| Value | Description |
|---|---|
| Spent | Used to purchase goods/services (taxable sale) |
| Gift | Given as a gift |
| Donation | Donated to charity |
| Lost | Lost or stolen BTC |

## Account Rules by Transaction Type

Each transaction type has specific account requirements. The system enforces these rules during validation.

| Type | From Account | To Account | Required Fields |
|---|---|---|---|
| Deposit | External | Any of your accounts | Into a bitcoin account (a wallet, or an exchange's BTC): cost_basis_usd required (0 if unknown); Income/Interest/Reward/Rebate: blank = that hour's value; Inherited: acquired_at (date of death) required; blank = that day's value |
| Withdrawal | Any of your accounts | External | From a bitcoin account (a wallet, or an exchange's BTC): purpose required; proceeds_usd for "Spent" |
| Transfer | One of your accounts | Another of your accounts, in the same currency; or the same bitcoin account | Fee in the sending account's currency; to the same account (a consolidation): a BTC fee is required, and only it is recorded |
| Buy | A bank, or an exchange's USD | An exchange's BTC (the same exchange's, when paid from its USD) | cost_basis_usd required; fee must be USD |
| Sell | An exchange's BTC | The same exchange's USD | proceeds_usd required; fee must be USD |

## Supported Date Formats

The following date formats are accepted. ISO8601 with timezone is recommended. A date or time without a timezone is read in your tax timezone (Settings → Account), and a date alone means noon that day, so it stays in the right tax year:

| Format | Example |
|---|---|
| ISO8601 with Z (preferred) | 2024-01-15T10:30:00Z |
| ISO8601 with timezone | 2024-01-15T10:30:00+00:00 |
| ISO8601 without timezone | 2024-01-15T10:30:00 |
| Date with time | 2024-01-15 10:30:00 |
| Date only | 2024-01-15 |
| US format with time | 01/15/2024 10:30:00 |
| US format date only | 01/15/2024 |

# Example Rows

Below are example CSV rows for each transaction type. Use these as templates for your own data.

### Buy from Exchange USD:

```
2024-01-15T10:30:00Z,Buy,0.012,Exchange USD,Exchange BTC,500.00,,5.00,USD,,,
```

### Buy paid from a bank:

```
2024-01-20T08:00:00Z,Buy,0.05,Bank,Exchange BTC,2500.00,,10.00,USD,,,
```

### Sell (selling BTC on exchange):

```
2024-02-15T11:30:00Z,Sell,0.3,Exchange BTC,Exchange USD,,15000.00,10.00,USD,,,
```

### Deposit (BTC entering your wallet):

```
2024-01-20T14:00:00Z,Deposit,0.5,External,Wallet,21000.00,,,,Income,,
```

### Withdrawal (spending BTC):

```
2024-03-01T09:00:00Z,Withdrawal,0.1,Wallet,External,,5500.00,,,,Spent,
```

### Transfer (moving between your accounts):

```
2024-02-01T16:45:00Z,Transfer,1.0,Exchange BTC,Wallet,,,0.0001,BTC,,,
```

### Transfer of USD with a fee ($1,000 left the bank, $990 arrived: amount 990, the $10 fee on top):

```
2024-02-03T12:00:00Z,Transfer,990.00,Bank,Exchange USD,,,10.00,USD,,,
```

### Transfer within the wallet (a consolidation: only the fee):

```
2024-02-05T09:00:00Z,Transfer,0.4,Wallet,Wallet,,,0.00005,BTC,,,
```

# Troubleshooting

### Common Errors

| Error | Solution |
|---|---|
| "Database has X existing transactions" | Delete all transactions from Settings before importing |
| "Invalid type '...'" | Use exactly: Deposit, Withdrawal, Transfer, Buy, or Sell |

| | |
|---|---|
| "Invalid account '...'" | Use one of your accounts by its name in Settings, or External (the error lists them). Bank, Wallet, Exchange USD and Exchange BTC always mean your first bank, wallet and exchange |
| "... is hidden in Settings" (a warning) | The row imports; show the account again in Settings if you still use it |
| "cost_basis_usd is required for Buy transactions" | Add the USD paid for the BTC, before the fee |
| "proceeds_usd is required for Sell transactions" | Add the gross USD, before the fee |
| "A BTC withdrawal needs a purpose" | From a wallet or an exchange's BTC, add purpose: Spent, Gift, Donation, or Lost |
| "A Buy is paid from a bank or from an exchange's USD account" | Buy must be: from a bank or an exchange's USD, to an exchange's BTC (the same exchange's, when paid from its USD) |
| "A Sell is from an exchange's BTC account" | Sell must be: from an exchange's BTC, to the same exchange's USD |
| "A Deposit comes from External" | Deposit must be: from External, to one of your accounts |
| "A Transfer goes to another account: only a bitcoin account can send to itself" | Only a wallet or an exchange's BTC can send to itself (a consolidation); a dollar account can't |
| "A consolidation within the same wallet or exchange records only its network fee" | A transfer from a wallet (or an exchange's BTC) to itself needs its fee_amount in BTC |

**Tip:** Use the Preview feature to validate your CSV before importing. Fix all errors shown in red before clicking Import.